

The Boston Globe

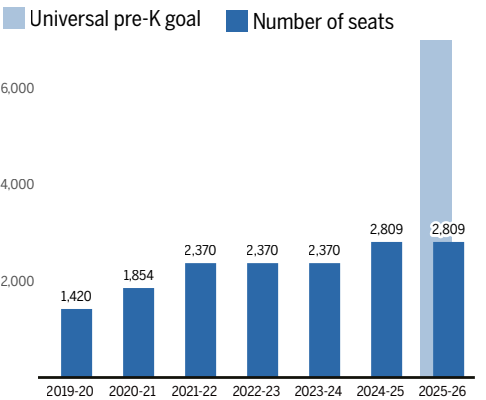
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TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 25, 2025

N.E. comes up short in universal pre-K slots

1,000 public pre-K seats in R.I. were added over five years

Number of seats remains far from universal pre-K goal



Data includes Head Start and R.I. state pre-K seats
Chart: STEPH MACHADO/GLOBE STAFF • Source: R.I. House Fiscal Staff

Officials agree on the need but paltry salaries for teachers and a lack of funds remain big obstacles

By Steph Machado
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — When Aimee Salazar Martinez became a pre-K teacher after graduating college, she made \$13 an hour.

“The first preschool I worked at paid me the same as Starbucks,” Salazar Martinez told a room full of New England mayors and early education experts Wednesday. “Realistically, most people would choose to work at Starbucks.”

She ended up moving back in with her mom and younger siblings to make ends meet. Now, eight years into her teaching ca-

reer and at a different center in Providence where her pay doubled, Salazar Martinez, 30, told the Globe she still makes less than the average kindergarten teacher.

“It’s a huge issue,” Salazar Martinez said.

Lower wages for preschool teachers, along with a lack of funding to open more classrooms, are among the chief impediments to achieving universal pre-K, experts said.

In New England, only one state — Vermont — offers universal pre-K for 4-year-olds, according to the National Institute

for Early Education Research, which defines “universal” as enrolling at least 70 percent of eligible children in free, full-time and high-quality preschool.

In Vermont, 82 percent of 4-year-olds were enrolled in either the state’s pre-K program or Head Start last school year, according to the institute.

Rhode Island is far behind with about 27 percent of 4-year-olds enrolled in public pre-K in 2024, according to the institute, while Massachusetts had 35 percent enrolled. Connecticut also had 27 percent and Maine had

UNIVERSAL PRE K, Page A7

Cases of Comey, James tossed

Judge rules prosecutor was unlawfully appointed

By Alan Feuer and Devlin Barrett
NEW YORK TIMES

A federal judge dismissed separate criminal charges against former FBI director James Comey and New York Attorney General Letitia James on Monday, saying the loyalist prosecutor installed by President Trump to bring the cases was put into her job unlawfully.

The twin rulings, by Judge Cameron McGowan Currie, were the most significant setback yet to the president’s efforts to force the criminal justice system to punish his perceived foes. The case dismissals also served as a rebuke to Attorney General Pam Bondi, who had rushed to carry out Trump’s orders to appoint the prosecutor, Lindsey Halligan, as the US attorney for the Eastern District of Virginia.

The dismissals, while embarrassing for the White House and the Justice Department, are unlikely to be the last word on an issue of constitutional authority that many legal experts expect could be appealed to the Supreme Court. And the way Currie rendered her decision left open the possibility that another prosecutor could refile the charges against both Comey and James.

Currie’s orders center on Trump’s unorthodox decision to appoint Halligan to her prosecutorial position in an interim capacity, replacing his previous pick, who was also serving in a temporary role. Within days after assuming her new post, Halligan rejected the advice of the career prosecutors in her new office and moved single-handedly to indict both Comey and James, two of the president’s most reviled targets.

In her rulings Monday, Currie said it was unlawful.
COMEY, Page A5

Catchy ICE names mask firm agenda

Tongue-in-cheek phrases, cheek-on-pavement tactics

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When federal immigration agents arrived in North Carolina on Nov. 15, they didn’t come just with the heavy resources and aggressive tactics that have drawn headlines and protests in other major cities this year. They also had a catchy name: Operation Charlotte’s Web.

It was the latest in a string of tongue-in-cheek names the Department of Homeland Security has given to operations as part of the Trump administration’s hard-line immigration enforcement agenda. They include Operation Patriot and Patriot 2.0 in Boston, and Operation Midway Blitz in Chicago.

The next operation is expected to arrive in New Orleans soon, and is to be called Operation Swamp Sweep, according to the Associated Press, or Catahoula Crunch, a reference to the official state dog of Louisiana, according to CBS News.

The names, which play on city and state nicknames or cultural histories, belie the aggressive nature of the enforcement. The Trump administration says they are removing “the worst of the worst” criminals from the country. But the sweeps have drawn reprimands from federal judges and local leaders who have accused immigration agents of using dangerous and indiscriminate tactics that have also swept up immigrants who did not have any criminal charges or had legal authorization to be in the United States, and even some US citizens.

Irreverent as they may be, experts say the monikers speak to the overall approach of the administration — leaning into the publicity and intimidation.

ICE, Page A6

A ROAD MORE TRAVELED



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

It is hard, between the brake lights on such roads as the Southeast Expressway and the long lines at Logan Airport, to remember that this is a season of reflection, of offering up our thanks, of spending quiet moments with family and friends, away from the clattering conflicts of contemporary life, writes Stan Grossfeld. **As I See It, B1.**

Trump tariffs threaten Canadian lumber

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

ENFIELD, Nova Scotia — One recent Wednesday morning, at a sawmill just north of Halifax, a labyrinth of conveyor belts fed hundreds of logs through machines that stripped their bark, then shaped and sorted them into neat piles. The distinct smell of fresh Christmas trees hung in the air.

Here at Ledwidge Lumber, the loud thrum of machinery obscures an unsettling lull. Business “has been very quiet this fall,” Carrie Turple, hard hat on and earplugs in, said inside the sawmill her family has run for generations.

That’s after President Trump in October levied a new 10 percent tariff on softwood timber and lumber, thrusting this 70-employee operation and one of

CANADA TARIFFS, Page A6

The fall of an economic principal

Summers has long been a survivor. Then came release of Epstein files.

By Laura Crimaldi, Aidan Ryan, and Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

A towering figure on the international stage, Lawrence H. Summers has used his deep knowledge of economics to quell business distress at home and abroad, lift barriers to a Harvard education for low-income students, and ease the pain of the Great Recession through government spending, even as some critics say his policies helped trigger the crisis.

Yet Summers’ contributions have frequently battled for attention with his abrasive style, displays of arrogance, and embrace of the spotlight.

It cost him the presidency at Harvard University nearly 20 years ago, but he remained prized for his intellect, influence, and authority. Summers held a prominent role in the Obama administration, has served on top corporate boards, and kept teaching at Harvard, where his



RICK FRIEDMAN

At a dinner at Harvard University in the fall of 2004, Jeffrey Epstein was flanked by Lawrence Summers (right) and Alan Dershowitz.

70th birthday last year was celebrated with an economic policy conference.

“Larry Summers is one of the great economic policymakers and commentators of the past four decades,” N. Gregory Mankiw, a Harvard economics professor, said in an email Saturday. “While I do not

share all of his views, I have no doubt that the world is a better place for his involvement in setting the nation’s economic agenda.”

Summers’ resilience to controversies that would have leveled most others is now facing its biggest test with the release this month of

SUMMERS, Page A7

US and Ukrainian mediators have cobbled together a slimmed-down peace framework, setting aside contentious issues that had favored Russia in an initial rendition. **A3.**

Who are the top Sox prospects? Alex Speier takes a look. **C1.**



Jimmy Cliff has died. The reggae legend (left) sang of resistance, resiliency, and joy. **C9.**

The Pentagon is investigating Senator Mark Kelly after the former astronaut took part in a video that reminded troops to refuse illegal orders. **A2.**



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Many rivers to cross

Tuesday: Rain late.

High 50-55, low 46-51.

Wednesday: More showers.

High 58-63, low 42-47.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C8-9.**

VOL. 308, NO. 148

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00

